

NATURE'S HEALTHY FOOD CABINET

Pocket Foraging Field Guide

Quick ID cards • Mushroom lookalikes • Seasonal calendar • Printable checklist

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How to Use This Guide

This pocket guide distills the field-ready essentials from *Nature's Healthy Food Cabinet*. Print it, fold it into your pack, or keep it on your phone.

- **Green cards** – wild greens and edibles
- **Herb cards** – wild and garden herbs
- **Mushroom cards** – each edible beside its dangerous lookalike
- **Do Not Touch** – deadly plants and mushrooms
- **Calendar & checklist** – plan your outings

Important safety notice

This guide is for general educational purposes only. It is **not medical advice** and is **not a substitute for expert, in-person identification**. Historical botanical illustrations are shown for interest; colors in old paintings vary, so never rely on them for identification. Always consult your doctor before using any herb or wild food for health purposes, especially if pregnant or breastfeeding, taking medication, or feeding children or older adults. The author and publisher accept no liability for any harm resulting from the use of this guide.

Poison Control (U.S.): 1-800-222-1222 · Emergencies: 911

The Golden Rules of Foraging

1. **Be 100% sure.** Never eat anything you have not identified with 100% certainty.
2. **Use multiple sources.** Check several reliable guides, not one photo or app.
3. **Learn from local experts.** Mycological societies, foraging walks, and extension offices.
4. **Know the lookalikes.** Every edible has one. Learn it before you pick.
5. **Avoid contaminated areas.** Skip busy roadsides, sprayed lawns, and polluted water.
6. **Start small.** Small portion, one new food at a time.
7. **Know who you're feeding.** Protect children, pregnant people, and the vulnerable.
8. **Know what to do in an emergency.** Poison Control 1-800-222-1222, or 911.

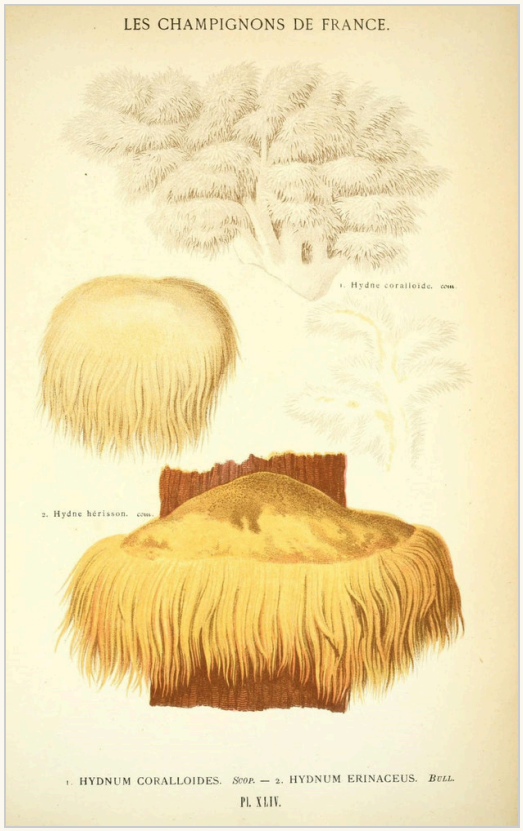
Mushroom safety essentials

Never eat a wild mushroom raw. Cook thoroughly. Eat a small portion the first time, one new species at a time. Don't eat old, soggy, or insect-riddled specimens. Avoid alcohol with unfamiliar mushrooms. Keep one uncooked specimen in the refrigerator in case of illness. Always dig up the entire mushroom: deadly Amanitas have a cup-like volva at the base that is often buried.

Ethics: get permission on private land, check park rules, and take only what you need (for ramps, one leaf per plant).

MUSHROOM ID CARD

Lion's Mane *Hericium erinaceus*



✔ Lion's Mane

- White shaggy ball of long, soft, dangling spines
- No cap, gills, or pores
- White when fresh, yellowing with age

Season: Late summer and fall

Where: Dead or wounded hardwoods

Uses: Cooked: sweet, tender, crab-like

☠ Lookalike: None close

- No toxic mushrooms closely resemble it
- Branched relatives (bear's head, comb tooth) are edible
- Still confirm every feature
- Enjoy it as food

Never eat a wild mushroom raw. If not 100% sure, don't eat it. Poison Control 1-800-222-1222